

Microsoft open sources its Quantum Development Kit

Microsoft has open sourced its Quantum Development Kit (QDK) on GitHub, and is inviting developers to contribute to its development to unlock the power of quantum computing.



First introduced two years ago, the QDK includes the Q# quantum programming language, and compiler, samples and tutorials to get started with quantum computing. It has simulators and resource estimators for quantum programs. The QDK also includes development environment extensions for VS and VS code, and integration with the Jupyter platform.

The tech giant is encouraging developers to contribute quantum apps and algorithms as well as advancements in compilation, optimisation and tooling to help advance the QDK.

“At Microsoft, our quantum mission is to develop and deploy the world’s most scalable, secure, quantum computing system and to support a rich ecosystem of domain experts, developers and researchers to solve today’s most challenging problems,” a Microsoft blog post stated.

“By open sourcing the Quantum Development Kit in GitHub, we enable developers to contribute alongside an emerging community of quantum computing programmers to help solve some of our world’s most important challenges,” it added.

The company noted that recent updates to the QDK, ranging from its open source efforts to the new ‘no install’ option, are designed to make it easier than ever for developers to engage with and contribute to its quantum initiatives.

LinuxForce announces a new suite of hosting services

LinuxForce, a leading technology services provider, has announced an expanded, comprehensive suite of hosting services for the effective maintenance and monitoring of computing operations.

Arduino donates US\$ 5,000 to RISC-V Foundation to stimulate open source collaboration

The RISC-V Foundation has received a donation of US\$ 5,000 from Arduino to advance the RISC-V ecosystem and other efforts focused on open source hardware and software development.

As a non-profit corporation, the RISC-V Foundation is focused on driving the adoption and implementation of the free and open RISC-V instruction set architecture (ISA) as well as fostering industry-wide collaboration.

This donation will further support the Foundation’s mission to develop open silicon and hardware implementations.

“Mutual support is absolutely necessary for open source communities like ours. As we support one another, we become more effective in changing the way the industry works together and collaborates. Arduino’s contribution pushes us forward, as we create a new kind of open hardware and software ecosystem,” said Calista Redmond, CEO of the RISC-V Foundation.

Arduino co-founder, Massimo Banzi, also highlighted that open source institutions and projects greatly depend on donations and community support.

“Our gift to the RISC-V Foundation is a token of our gratitude as we value the RISC-V ecosystem for its contributions to the open source community, and we look forward to continuing to witness the growth of this ecosystem,” Banzi said.



Founded in 2015, the RISC-V Foundation comprises more than 250 members. These members have access to and participate in the development of the RISC-V ISA specifications and the related hardware-software ecosystem.